# Writing about myself

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

## Qué vas a aprender

- Write a short text about yourself: name, age, family, likes and abilities
- Use capital letters, full stops and the connectors and, but, because
- Plan a text with a mind map before writing
- Check and improve your writing with a checklist

## Para pensar

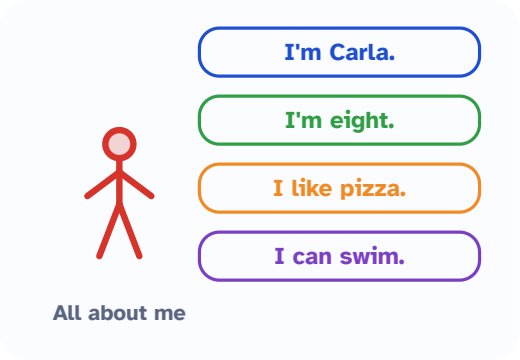
**Tienes un amigo por correspondencia en Inglaterra y quieres presentarte por escrito. ¿Qué cosas le contarías de ti y cómo lo ordenarías?**

## Explicación

### All about me

Writing about yourself is a great way to use all the English you know. In a text about you, you can write: your **name** and **age**, where you **live**, what you **look like**, your **family** and **pets**, what you **like** and what you **can** do.

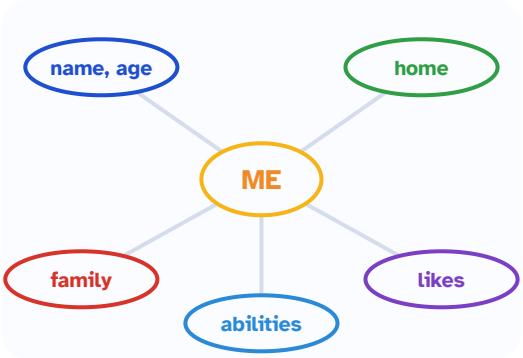
You already know the sentences! «I'm Carla.» «I'm eight.» «I've got a brother.» «I like pizza.» «I can swim.» Ahora solo hay que ordenarlas y unirlas para que formen un texto bonito.




### Plan first: a mind map

Before writing, make a mind map (mapa de ideas). Write **ME** in the centre. Draw lines to five bubbles: **name and age**, **home**, **family**, **likes** and **abilities**. In each bubble, write words, not sentences: «Carla, 8», «Sevilla, flat», «1 brother, 1 cat», «pizza, dancing», «swim, draw».

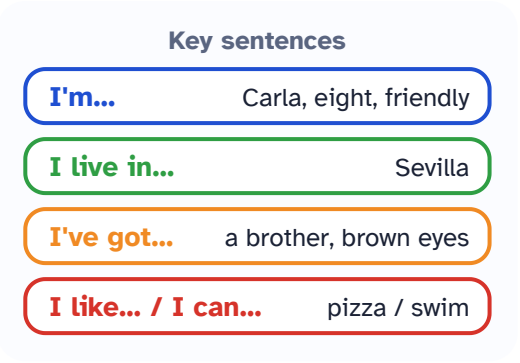
The mind map helps you remember everything and put it in order. **Consejo:** los buenos escritores siempre planifican antes de escribir, ¡hasta en su lengua materna!



## Sentences that start with I

Most sentences in your text start with `I`. **Ojo:** en inglés, *I* (yo) se escribe **siempre con mayúscula**, aunque esté en mitad de la frase: «My sister and **I** like music.»

Use the key verbs: **I'm** + name, age or adjective («I'm friendly»), **I live in** + place, **I've got** + family, pets, hair and eyes, **I like** / **I love** + things, **I can** + abilities. With these five you can write a lot!




## Capital letters and full stops

Every sentence starts with a capital letter (mayúscula) and ends with a full stop (punto). «**M**y name is Carla**.**» We also use capital letters for: names (**C**arla, **L**eo), places (**S**evilla, **S**pain), days and months (**M**onday, **M**ay), languages and nationalities (**E**nglish, **S**panish) and **I**.

**En castellano:** en español «lunes», «mayo» y «español» van en minúscula. En inglés, no: Monday, May, Spanish llevan mayúscula.

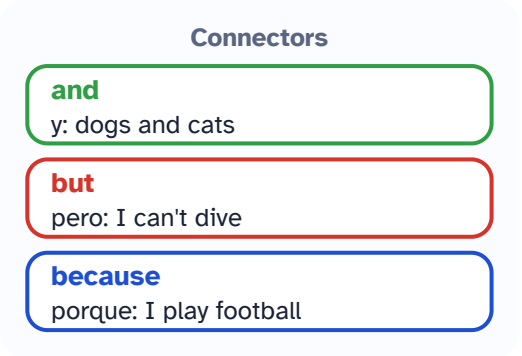



## Joining ideas: and, but, because

Short sentences are OK, but we can join them with connectors to make the text better. **And** (y) adds ideas: «I like dogs **and** cats.» **But** (pero) shows a contrast: «I

can swim, **but** I can't dive.» **Because** (porque) gives a reason: «I love Saturdays **because** I play football.»

Compare: «I've got a cat. I've got a dog.» → «I've got a cat **and** a dog.» ¡Queda mucho mejor! Intenta usar cada conector al menos una vez.




## Paragraphs

A good text has got paragraphs (párrafos): groups of sentences about the same idea. For a text about you, you can write three paragraphs. **Paragraph 1:** name, age, home and appearance. **Paragraph 2:** family and pets. **Paragraph 3:** likes, hobbies and abilities.

Start with a greeting, «**Hello!**» or «**Hi!**», and finish with a goodbye: «**Write soon!**» or «**Bye for now!**». Each paragraph starts on a new line.




## A model text

Read Carla's text: «Hello! My name's **Carla** and I'm eight years old. I live in a flat in Sevilla, in Spain. I've got long black hair and brown eyes.

I've got one brother, Leo, **and** a cat called Misi. My grandma lives with us. I love reading comics **and** dancing. My favourite food is pizza. I can swim very well, **but**

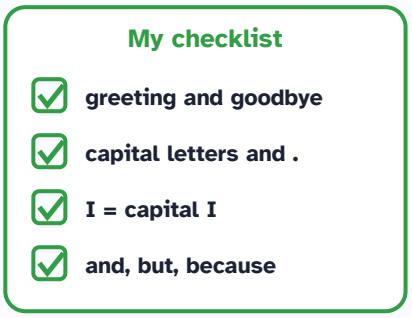
I can't ride a horse. I love Saturdays **because** I go to the beach with my family. Write soon! Carla»

| topic | Carla |
|---|---|
| **age** | eight |
| **home** | a flat in Sevilla |
| **family** | Leo, cat Misi |
| **can** | swim very well |

## Check your writing

When you finish, read your text again and use a checklist: ✓ Have I got a greeting and a goodbye? ✓ Does every sentence start with a capital letter and end with a full stop? ✓ Is *I* always a capital letter? ✓ Have I used **and**, **but** and **because**? ✓ Have I written about my family, likes and abilities?

You can also swap texts with a partner and give **two stars and a wish**: two things you like and one thing to improve. «I like your connectors. I like your pet. Wish: use more capital letters.»

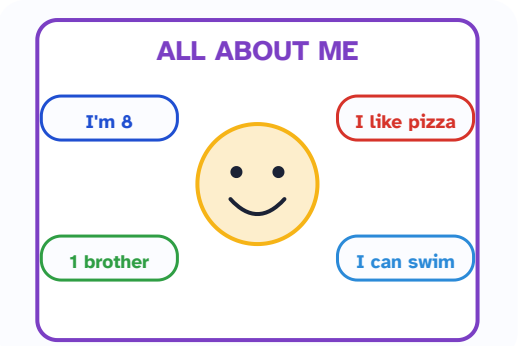



## Let's practise: my «All about me» poster

Now it's your turn! 1) Make your **mind map**. 2) Write your text in three paragraphs. 3) Check it with the **checklist**. 4) Copy it neatly onto a big card, with a photo or a self-portrait in the middle.

Hang the posters on the wall and do a **gallery walk**: walk around, read your classmates' posters and find something in common: «Lucas likes dogs too!»,

«Ana can swim, like me!». ¿Cuántas cosas en común encuentras?




## Writing about myself

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **PLAN** | **WRITE** | **JOIN** | **CHECK** |
| mind map<br>five bubbles | I'm, I've got<br>I like, I can | and, but<br>because | capital letters<br>full stops |

## Ejercicios

1. **Escribe una frase con tu nombre y tu edad.**

2. **Escribe dónde vives.**

3. **Describe tu pelo y tus ojos.**

4. **Pon mayúsculas: «on monday i speak english».**

5. **Une con but: «I can draw. I can't sing.»**

6. **Completa con because: «I like Fridays ___ I go swimming.»**

7. **¿Qué es un mind map?**

8. **Escribe un saludo y una despedida para tu texto.**

9. **Escribe dos cosas que comprobar al terminar.**

10. **Escribe un párrafo de 4 frases sobre ti.**

## Practica

1. **Before writing, we make a...**

   **A)** full stop
   **B)** mind map
   **C)** poster

2. **The word I is always...**

   **A)** a capital letter
   **B)** a small letter
   **C)** in red

3. **A sentence ends with a...**

   **A)** capital letter
   **B)** comma
   **C)** full stop

4. **Which needs a capital letter?**

   **A)** dog
   **B)** pizza
   **C)** Monday

5. **I like cats ___ dogs.**

   **A)** and
   **B)** but
   **C)** because

6. **I can swim, ___ I can't dive.**

   **A)** and
   **B)** but
   **C)** because

7. **I love Sundays ___ I visit my grandma.**

   **A)** because
   **B)** but
   **C)** and

8. **«I've got a brother» talks about...**

   **A)** abilities

**B)** likes

**C)** family

9. **«I can ride a bike» talks about...**

**A)** family

**B)** abilities

**C)** home

10. **A good goodbye is...**

**A)** Hello!

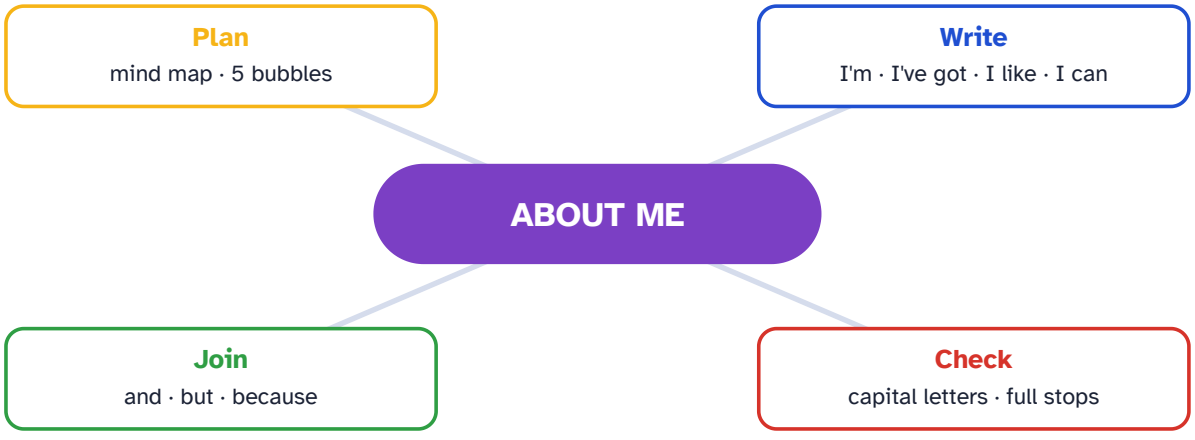
**B)** Write soon!

**C)** I'm eight.

## Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Qué cosas puedo contar en un texto sobre mí; Cómo planifico con un mapa de ideas; Qué palabras llevan mayúscula en inglés; Cómo uno ideas con and, but y because y reviso mi texto.

## Resumen



## Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

**mind map**

Mapa de ideas para planificar.

**capital letter**

Mayúscula: I, Monday, Spain.

**full stop**

Punto al final de la frase.

**and**

Y: añade ideas.

**but**

Pero: contraste.

**because**

Porque: da una razón.

**paragraph**

Grupo de frases sobre una idea.

**checklist**

Lista para revisar el texto.

## Soluciones

1. **B)** Plan.
2. **A)** Mayúscula.
3. **C)** Punto.
4. **C)** Días con mayúscula.
5. **A)** Añadir: and.
6. **B)** Contraste: but.
7. **A)** Razón: because.
8. **C)** Familia.
9. **B)** Habilidad.
10. **B)** Despedida.

## Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. My name's... and I'm... years old.
2. I live in... (ciudad o pueblo).
3. I've got short brown hair and green eyes (por ejemplo).
4. On Monday I speak English.
5. I can draw, but I can't sing.
6. because.
7. Un mapa de ideas para planificar antes de escribir.
8. Hello! ... Write soon! (o Bye for now!).
9. Mayúsculas y puntos; usar and, but y because.
10. Model answer: Hello! I'm Mario and I'm nine. I live in Zaragoza. I've got a sister and I love football because it's fun.